Gemcitabine

Original Effective Date: 8/1/2022
Revision Date(s): 8/1/2022, 12/12/2022, 11/7/2023, 2/10/2025, 1/1/2026, 02/16/2026
Review Date: 02/16/2026
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Non-Preferred	No	**Gemzar**	**J9201**	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride, not otherwise specified, 200 mg
Preferred	No	**Gemcitabine (Accord)**	**J9196**	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (accord), not therapeutically equivalent to J9201, 200 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	**Avgemsi**	**J9184**	Injection, gemcitabine hydrochloride (avyxa), 200 mg

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product.
- Preferred product requirements apply to all requests, both new starts and reauthorizations.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
    - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
    - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals: